

# Weaning from CPB



Flow and drainage are reduced as deliberately as they were raised — every pre-wean condition must be confirmed first.

## 1 Closed loop communication

## 2 Pre-wean checklist

Confirm every item before touching the venous line.

## 3 Communication

- Partially occlude venous line — reduce drainage gradually
- Allow the heart to fill

## 4 Reduce arterial flow in step

- Match flow reduction to venous reduction
- Watch for return of pulsatile arterial waveform and rising CVP

## 5 Communication

Assess native contractility on TOE.  
Adjust inotropes / vasopressors as directed.

## 6 Off bypass

Once native cardiac output and BP are adequate, clamp the venous line.

## 7 Decannulate & reverse heparin

- Venous then arterial cannula removed
- Protamine given — confirm ACT normalised

"Weaning from bypass"

### PRE-WEAN CHECKLIST

- ☐ Core temperature 36 - 37°C
- ☐ K<sup>+</sup> / Ca<sup>2+</sup> / pH / ABG corrected
- ☐ Hb / Hct acceptable
- ☐ Stable rhythm on ECG
- ☐ Heart de-aired
- ☐ Ventilation resumed
- ☐ All monitors & lines checked

"Reducing venous drainage"

### KEY VALUES

| Parameter              | Target                   |
|------------------------|--------------------------|
| Reduction style        | Flow & drainage together |
| Target trace           | Pulsatile, CVP rising    |
| Reversal agent         | Protamine                |
| Confirm before leaving | ACT normalised           |

### ⚠️ NEVER REDUCE FLOW ALONE

Flow and venous drainage reduce together in small steps — exact mirror of going on bypass.

"Assessing cardiac function"

"Off bypass"

"Bypass complete, protamine given"